AND JUSTICE FOR ALL

Q+A

The courtroom drama *Patna Shuklla* is actor **Raveena Tandon**'s way of highlighting burning social issues

Q. What drew you to *Patna Shuklla*?

I didn't know of the roll number change scam where a student gets cheated of the work they have done. The script really hit me because I have two kids who are also students. All my career I have liked doing films with a strong message. It is important to have a certain moral responsibility and make some contribution to society with the films I do.

Q. Do you think the industry has become more age agnostic in the roles it offers women?

Absolutely. I can give a bit of credit to the OTT platforms. Suddenly, audiences are exposed to so much international cinema, different cultures and kinds of storytelling that it has broadened their horizons. Filmmakers now have the freedom to tell the stories that they were earlier afraid of experimenting with.

Q. 2024 is a seminal year for you. Your daughter, Rasha, also makes her screen debut. What words of wisdom did you give her?

It was pretty cool because in January there were billboards of me in *Karmma Calling* alongside Rasha's first ad as model for a jewellery brand. With both my kids–Rasha and Ranbir–I have tried to make their foundation solid. I have told them to be successful as human beings first and then chase professional success. They have to learn from their mistakes, for life is the biggest teacher.

Q. The upcoming *Welcome to the Jungle* sees you do the sort of multi-starrer comedy that was routine back in the 1990s...

I'm working with all my old friends again and the set is like a picnic. In fact, Farida Jalalji and I are working after a very long time; so we spend the whole day catching up. Nobody wants to check their phones because we all have so much to talk about.

–with Suhani Singh



Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**